



Figure 1: Setting up the Axigen admin password

save the file:

```
zone "example.com" IN {
type master;
file "forward";
allow-update { none; };
};
```

Next, run: `cd var/named; cp named.localhost forward; chgrp named forward` after which edit the *forward* file and add the following lines and save them:

```
$TTL 1D
@ IN SOA server.example.com. root.server.example.com. (
    0 ; serial
    1D ; refresh
    1H ; retry
    1M ; expire
    3H ; minimum
)
@ IN NS server.example.com.
server IN A 192.168.0.1
client IN A 192.168.0.2
```

Now start the service by running the *service named start* command. Run the *setup* command on both machines, and set 192.168.0.1 as their DNS server. You'll have to bring the network interface up and down to apply the changed settings. You may further need to adjust your firewall settings on both machines, or you can turn it off using the *service iptables stop* command. After this, you should be able to ping between the two machines.

Now the DNS server is configured and running properly; though it's just a minimal configuration, it'll still do the job for us. Now, open the Axigen admin panel by visiting 127.0.0.1:9000 in your browser. Here, enter *admin* as the username and give the password you set during the Axigen configuration process. Now select *Services-DNR-Add Nameserver* and give the address of your DNS server (192.168.0.1). Save your settings, select *Domains & Accounts-Manage Accounts-Add Account* and create an



Figure 2: Axigen domain configuration

account under the domain *server.example.com*. Set the DNS server for Axigen on the second machine with the same steps, and create an account on that machine under the domain *client.example.com*.

That's all about the configuration. At this point, my overall configuration looks like this:

	Machine 1	Machine2
Hostname	server.example.com	client.
example.com		
IP	192.168.0.1	192.168.0.2
Axigen domain	server.example.com	
client.example.com		
Mail account name	vinayak	viny
DNS server address	192.168.0.1	

It's time to log in to your mail accounts, and get a first look at Axigen. Point your browser to 127.0.0.1, and log in with the username and password for the mail account you just created. I logged in to my mail account on the first machine (*vinayak@server.example.com*) and sent a mail to another mail account on another machine (*viny@client.example.com*); and when I logged on to *viny@client.example.com* on another machine, I received that mail. So what I have right now is a fully functional mail server, up and running within a few minutes.

Axigen is a commercial mail server, and here we've used a 30-day trial version of it. Many of us will find it pointless paying for a mail server when a number of free mail server packages like SquirrelMail are easily available, but it's always good to evaluate all options before going for one of them. So I'll leave the job of evaluating and exploring Axigen to you, as no one knows your requirements better than you do. 

By: Vinayak Pandey

The author is a Red Hat Certified Engineer and open source enthusiast currently working for TCS in Kolkata. Catch his blog: <https://hacktips.wordpress.com>.